

Cinerific Android App Work Log - September 23, 2026 (U.S. EST)

Compiled summary for Wednesday, September 23, 2026 (U.S. Eastern Time) - focus: continuing the post-September-21 portrait and playback pass by reviewing the current project snapshot and every prior Cinerific worklog, booting and validating the standalone Standard tablet AVD and connected Samsung phone, redesigning the logged-in portrait navigation for readable scale and crisp high-resolution artwork, adding bidirectional video-reel swiping without exposing playback controls, synchronizing reel titles to settled playback, refining portrait title and logo placement, matching phone title-card proportions to tablets, protecting destination headers from the phone status toolbar, and introducing a reversible full-screen portrait reel experiment with subject-aware framing and unchanged scrollable genre rows.

Generated in continuity with the established Cinerific worklog cadence from July 12 through September 21 Part 2: compact opening summary, source-material review, baseline state, goals, themed work-completed sections, validation, files touched, follow-up context, and output-artifact close. No September 23 worklog existed before this artifact, so it uses the first-log-of-day filename without a part suffix. Eastern Time was verified from the host as Wednesday, September 23, 2026 at 10:53 PM EDT, UTC-04:00. The title retains the repository's established U.S. EST label while the body records the seasonally accurate EDT verification. This artifact covers commits 46fb0c7, 28ceaa7, 5abc024, and 465570a on main, plus the refreshed project snapshot produced during this documentation pass.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Reviewed every pre-existing Cinerific worklog PDF at the repository root: July 12, July 14, July 15 Part 1, July 15, July 16, July 18, July 19, July 20, July 22, July 23, July 24, July 25, July 27, July 28 Part 1, July 28 Part 2, July 29, August 1, August 3, August 4, August 5, September 19, September 21, and September 21 Part 2.
- Converted all twenty-three earlier PDFs with pdftotext and inspected their title cadence, opening-summary density, source-review language, baseline and goals sections, themed work-completed sections, validation phrasing, file inventories, follow-up closes, and output-artifact wording.
- Ran pdfinfo and pdffonts across the worklog set, using September 21 Part 2 as the closest template, to preserve four U.S. Letter pages, Helvetica body type, PDF 1.4 compatibility, text extraction, Codex metadata, and right-aligned footer treatment.
- Ran ./read_project.sh and reviewed the refreshed cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt for the current source tree, Kotlin implementation, drawable inventory, launcher and emulator files, worklog inventory, and September 23 timestamp.
- Reviewed git history, commit messages, stats, and Kotlin diffs for all four September 23 commits, then checked current branch and working-tree state before producing this artifact.
- Reviewed CinerificHomeScreen.kt, HeroPresentationTextAnimation.kt, CinerificRightSideNavBar.kt, and CinerificDestinationScreen.kt around navigation geometry, reel state, video transforms, portrait overlays, responsive card sizing, destination headers, and scroll behavior.
- Reviewed all four repository hero MP4s and representative decoded frames, including source resolution, aspect ratio, principal subject placement, and the limitations of enlarging landscape footage into tall portrait viewports.

Baseline Status Before September 23 Work

- Cinerific entered September 23 with the dedicated portrait intro, high-resolution profile avatars, responsive S21-derived intro scaling, profile slide-and-fade motion, stable cold-launch timing, and the low-load Standard tablet QA environment completed on September 21.
- The logged-in bottom navigation remained too small on portrait phones, with undersized labels and icons, uneven visual alignment, and visibly soft legacy raster assets.
- Home video reels advanced automatically but did not yet offer deliberate bidirectional card swiping, and rapidly queued changes could let title artwork advance ahead of the video that had actually settled.
- Portrait reels still exposed small description and genre text, while phone title and logo sizing required additional safe-area and clipping work.
- Phone home cards were sized from visible-count arithmetic rather than the tablet's genre-label-to-card proportion, and destination headings could rise into the native phone toolbar.
- Portrait reel height occupied only part of the viewport; genre rows were immediately visible beneath it rather than reached by scrolling from a full-screen playback presentation.

Main Goals for September 23

- Make logged-in portrait navigation legible, aligned, and crisp on both phones and large tablets.
- Add card-local horizontal reel navigation while preserving vertical page scrolling, tap-to-open playback controls, automatic playback, and established transition effects.
- Keep title artwork synchronized with the video that has actually settled and restore correct portrait and landscape presentation after orientation changes.
- Match phone card proportions to tablets without changing genre text sizes, and protect destination headers from system UI.
- Test a reversible full-screen portrait reel that preserves overlay placement and leaves the existing genre rows available below it.

Work Completed - Portrait Navigation Scale and Alignment

- Introduced a portrait-specific navigation scale derived from a 360 dp reference width and clamped it between phone and tablet limits, separating portrait sizing from the pre-existing landscape rail geometry.
- Iteratively reduced the initially oversized portrait bar until its overall height, icon slots, and labels matched the accepted phone and tablet balance.
- Reworked the five-item row around stable item widths and icon slots so dynamic scaling no longer changed the navigation layout footprint.
- Aligned Movies, Shows, and Favorites vertically to the Home icon while enlarging those three featured symbols independently of their labels.
- Moved all five labels downward toward the screen edge without moving their icons, preserving a consistent text baseline and improving separation between symbol and label.
- Kept Home, Movies, Shows, Favorites, and Settings hit areas and destination routing unchanged throughout the visual revisions.

Work Completed - High-Resolution Navigation Artwork

- Searched the repository for higher-resolution navigation artwork and confirmed the active assets were tiny raster files that became visibly blurred when enlarged.
- Used the supplied Cinerific Figma design references to recover cleaner source artwork for all five navigation destinations.
- Replaced nav_icon_home.png, nav_icon_movies.png, nav_icon_shows.png, nav_icon_favorites.png, and nav_icon_settings.png with substantially larger drawable-nodpi exports suitable for phone and tablet rendering.
- Identified the Favorites star's residual grain as overlapping edge treatment in the source artwork rather than Android scaling alone.
- Simplified and re-exported the Favorites star so its outline reads cleanly at the enlarged navigation size without the prior noisy double-edge effect.

Work Completed - Reel Swipe Interaction

- Added horizontal gesture recognition directly to the currently displayed video reel card rather than attaching a swipe listener to the whole screen.
- Separated horizontal reel gestures from vertical page movement using touch-slop and axis-intent checks, allowing the parent home page to continue scrolling normally.
- Added cyclic left and right reel selection with a 48 dp commit threshold and preserved tap behavior for opening the currently playing program.
- Kept the forward, play, and back playback controls exclusive to tapping the active reel; swiping now changes and plays the requested reel without surfacing those controls.
- Stored requested and displayed reel indices separately with saveable state so queued user intent no longer masquerades as completed playback.
- Updated visible title artwork only from the player's settled-reel callback, preventing rapid consecutive swipes from changing titles while the previous video remained onscreen.

Work Completed - Reel Transition and Playback Polish

- Extended the native looping video view to animate incoming reels from either horizontal direction while retaining automatic advancement and preload behavior.
- Made the incoming edge blend follow swipe direction and progressively shrink with remaining travel instead of snapping a fixed dark gradient into place.
- Reset edge-mask direction and width after every completed transition so later automatic or user-requested changes begin from a clean visual state.
- Queued fast swipe requests with their intended direction and resumed them only after the active animation settled, keeping video, title, and transition state coordinated.
- Preserved MediaPlayer preparation, looping sequence, muted playback, TextureView reuse, and the existing seven-hundred-millisecond decelerated slide timing.

Work Completed - Portrait Reel Text and Logo

- Removed the small description and genre snippets from portrait reel overlays while retaining the full presentation in landscape.
- Moved portrait title bands into a bottom-oriented position and added per-presentation lift multipliers so Into The Wild and the two-line Light As Air artwork align visually with the other titles.
- Increased phone portrait title artwork and the Cinerific logo through a shared 1.44 visual scale while preserving their established bottom and top edge anchors.
- Offset the phone portrait logo below the status toolbar and recalculated scaled title clipping from the band's bottom edge, eliminating invisible-boundary clipping after enlargement.
- Kept tablet portrait sizing and all landscape title, description, genre, and logo behavior on their existing paths.

Work Completed - Responsive Home Cards

- Replaced phone portrait visible-card-count arithmetic with explicit card-width-to-genre-text ratios based on the accepted tablet composition.
- Derived portrait and landscape card widths from the unchanged 36 sp genre heading size, using separate 6.9 and 8.34 proportional factors.
- Preserved title-card aspect ratio, corner treatment, gaps, selection stroke, horizontal scrolling, catalog routing, and every existing genre row behavior.
- Verified that genre heading sizes did not change on phones; only the card dimensions moved into the tablet-derived proportional system.
- Kept tablet portrait and landscape results visually stable while bringing both phone orientations into the same proportional rule.

Work Completed - Destination Header Protection

- Added a compact-phone portrait-only 28 dp allowance to the shared destination top-bar height calculation.
- Moved Movies, Shows, Favorites, and Settings headings below the native status toolbar while retaining typography, horizontal position, and bottom alignment.
- Applied the gap through the shared destination geometry so body content follows the heading naturally rather than overlapping or receiving one-off offsets.
- Left Home, tablets, and every landscape destination layout unchanged through the 600 dp phone breakpoint.

Work Completed - Full-Screen Portrait Reel Experiment

- Added `ENABLE_PORTRAIT_FULLSCREEN_HERO_EXPERIMENT` as a single reversible switch while retaining the prior natural and 48-percent portrait height calculation in the disabled branch.
- Expanded phone and tablet portrait reels to the complete usable viewport above Cinerific's persistent bottom navigation instead of drawing behind the navigation and obscuring title artwork.
- Preserved the Cinerific logo's top anchor and the title stack's bottom anchor, allowing their established relative placement to scale naturally with the taller reel.
- Kept the home Column vertically scrollable so users can move past the full-screen reel into the unchanged genre headings and title-card carousels below.
- Left landscape reel height calculations untouched and preserved horizontal reel gestures, automatic playback, title synchronization, edge blending, tap routing, and genre-row selection behavior.

Work Completed - Subject-Aware Portrait Framing

- Inspected representative source frames for Light As Air, Infatuation, Into The Wild, and Morbid Temptations to identify the airplane, central character, frog, and hand as principal focal subjects.
- Replaced the universal center-crop transform with a portrait-only focal transform while retaining exact center crop in landscape.
- Assigned per-reel horizontal focal fractions and clamped translation against both image edges so subject positioning cannot reveal unfilled video space.
- Adjusted Light As Air back to a centered motion envelope after live playback showed that the moving paraglider crosses more of the frame than its static thumbnail suggested.
- Confirmed that focal positioning improves subject retention but cannot recover scenery absent from the narrow portrait slice.

Source Resolution and Framing Findings

- Verified the repository videos as H.264 landscape files: Light As Air, Into The Wild, and Morbid Temptations are 1280 by 720; Infatuation is 1280 by 676; each runs for eight seconds.
- Documented that filling a tall portrait viewport requires roughly 2.4-times magnification on the phone and retains only about 35 to 40 percent of the source width.
- Explained that focal cropping can choose which content survives but cannot simultaneously retain the full landscape composition and avoid enlargement.
- Identified 1080 by 1920 portrait masters as the practical minimum for a later replacement, with 1440 by 2560 or larger preferred for large-tablet clarity.
- Kept the current experiment at the user's request while leaving alternate portrait video masters as the correct future path for wider framing and reduced grain.

Work Completed - Device and Orientation QA

- Built, installed, and relaunched the same debug APK repeatedly on Samsung SM-G990U R5CRC33MGNZ and the Cinerific Standard tablet AVD at emulator-5554.
- Validated portrait reel framing, title visibility, logo clearance, navigation overlap, vertical scrolling, and subject placement on the physical phone.
- Recovered the tablet AVD from a temporary Android system-not-responding state, restored automatic rotation, rebooted it, reinstalled the APK, and completed the portrait check.
- Confirmed the final tablet portrait reel filled the usable screen above navigation with the full title visible and the airplane retained in frame.

Validation and Checks Performed

- Verified host Eastern Time with TZ=America/New_York; the system reported Wednesday, September 23, 2026 at 10:53 PM EDT, UTC-04:00.
- Used pdftotext on all twenty-three earlier worklogs and pdfinfo/pdffonts on the latest artifact before generating this document.
- Ran ./gradlew :app:assembleDebug throughout the navigation, reel, card, header, and full-screen experiment passes; all final builds reported BUILD SUCCESSFUL.
- Ran git diff --check after implementation passes without whitespace errors.
- Verified commits 46fb0c7, 28ceaa7, 5abc024, and 465570a and reviewed their complete file stats and Kotlin changes.
- Used adb device inventories, installs, launches, orientation controls, input gestures, screen captures, window checks, and app-state resets across the phone and tablet AVD.
- Visually inspected all five navigation items, every destination header, home card proportions, all four reel subjects, horizontal transitions, title synchronization, and vertical genre-row access.
- Used macOS metadata and Quick Look decoding to verify video dimensions, duration, codec, and representative source framing.
- Regenerated cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt with ./read_project.sh after the four source commits so the project record reflects the latest source and worklog inventory.

Files Touched During September 23

- app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/CinerificRightSideNavBar.kt: added portrait-specific navigation scaling, stable item and icon slots, featured-icon enlargement, vertical alignment, label sizing, and bottom placement.
- app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/CinerificHomeScreen.kt: added reel-local bidirectional gestures, requested-versus-settled state, directional transitions, responsive card proportions, full-screen portrait sizing, reversible experiment control, and subject-aware video transforms.
- app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/HeroPresentationTextAnimation.kt: added portrait title-only rendering, per-title lift, visual scaling, and bottom-preserving band clipping.
- app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/CinerificDestinationScreen.kt: added the phone portrait header clearance shared by Movies, Shows, Favorites, and Settings.
- app/src/main/res/drawable-nodpi/nav_icon_home.png, nav_icon_movies.png, nav_icon_shows.png, nav_icon_favorites.png, and nav_icon_settings.png: replaced legacy low-resolution navigation graphics with high-resolution Figma-derived artwork.
- cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt: refreshed after the source work and again during this documentation pass.
- cinerific_worklog_september 23.pdf: added this first and latest Eastern-Time worklog for September 23.

Follow-Up Context

- The full-screen portrait reel remains intentionally experimental. Setting ENABLE_PORTRAIT_FULLSCREEN_HERO_EXPERIMENT to false restores the prior portrait height calculation without removing the completed swipe and playback work.
- Current portrait focal points are static per reel. They follow each subject's useful motion envelope but do not perform frame-by-frame object tracking.
- The 1280-pixel-wide landscape videos are the limiting factor for portrait image quality and retained visual area; crop math alone cannot produce a wider, sharper portrait image.
- Future replacement footage should use portrait or open-gate masters with each principal subject framed inside a common safe area, preferably at 1440 by 2560 or higher for large tablets.
- Landscape video presentation remains centered and unchanged, and portrait genre/title cards retain the proportional and interaction rules approved earlier in the day.
- The standalone AVD returned to automatic rotation after recovery and remained available alongside the USB Samsung phone.

Output Artifact

- Generated cinerific_worklog_september 23.pdf at the repository root using the first-log-of-the-day no-part filename convention.
- Preserved the established four-page U.S. Letter layout, Helvetica text, PDF 1.4 compatibility, Codex metadata, right-aligned page footers, and plain-text-readable structure.
- Used the verified September 23, 2026 U.S. Eastern date and documented the actual EDT offset while retaining the historical U.S. EST title label.
- Recorded main through 465570a plus the refreshed project snapshot; the artifact is ready for repository review and commit.